

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 3

Chapter 18: The State, the Government, and You

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	18 — The State, the Government, and You
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic traps: confusing the state (four parts: population, territory, government, sovereignty; endures) with the government (one part; changes at elections); treating police/army or the bureaucracy as 'the government'; assuming every democracy is a republic (the UK keeps a monarch); assuming the majority may do anything (rights and the rule of law shield minorities); mixing up the three organs (legislature makes, executive enforces, judiciary interprets), the three roles (protector, provider, regulator), and the three tiers (union, state, local). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. In 2019 a country held an election and a new party formed the government; in 2024 yet another party won. Through both changes, the same people, the same borders, and the same power to make its own laws stayed in place. Which conclusion is best supported?

- (A) The state changed twice, but the government stayed exactly the same throughout.
- (B) The government changed twice, but the state - its population, territory and sovereignty - endured.
- (C) Both the state and the government were completely replaced at each election.
- (D) Neither the state nor the government can ever change once formed.

2. A textbook lists four things and says 'a state must have all of these.' Three of the four it lists are correct parts of a state. Which item is the IMPOSTER that does NOT belong among the four parts of a state?

- (A) A permanent population
- (B) A defined territory
- (C) Sovereignty (full power to make its own laws)

(D) An independent judiciary

3. Using the chapter's analogy, a school keeps running while its teachers come and go over the years. If the school is matched to the state, what does the analogy most precisely warn us NOT to conclude?

(A) That the teachers (the government) can change while the school (the state) continues.

(B) That when the teachers (the government) leave, the school (the state) ceases to exist.

(C) That the school (the state) is more lasting than any one set of teachers (any one government).

(D) That different teachers (governments) can run the same school (state) over time.

4. Two friends argue. Riya says 'the state is just the buildings where ministers sit.' Sam says 'the state is whichever party is currently in power.' Who is right, and why?

(A) Riya is right; without the ministers' buildings there is no state.

(B) Sam is right; the state is simply the party that won the last election.

(C) Both are right, since buildings and the ruling party together make up the whole state.

(D) Neither; the state is the political organisation of a population on a territory with sovereignty, not buildings and not the ruling party.

5. A new nation is recognised. It has a settled population and clearly marked borders, but a stronger neighbour must approve every law it wishes to pass. Which essential part of a full state is this nation MOST clearly missing?

(A) Population

(B) Territory

(C) Government

(D) Sovereignty

6. Which statement correctly captures how 'making, enforcing and interpreting laws' relates to the state and the government?

(A) It is the government's work, done through its three organs; the population, territory and sovereignty are the state's other parts and do not do this work.

(B) It is the work of the population, which directly writes and judges every law itself.

(C) It is done by the territory, since laws apply to the land.

(D) It is the work of sovereignty acting on its own, separate from any organ of government.

7. A citizen claims, 'If the ruling party loses, the country loses its government, its laws and its sovereignty all at once.' How many of these three would actually be lost when a party loses an election?

(A) All three are lost the moment the party leaves office.

(B) Only sovereignty is lost; the government and laws continue.

(C) None of the three is lost - a new government forms, the laws continue, and sovereignty stays with the state.

(D) Only the laws are lost, while the government and sovereignty continue.

8. Which pairing correctly distinguishes the state from the government?

(A) The government has four parts and endures; the state is one part that changes with elections.

(B) Both have four parts and both change identically at every election.

(C) The state is one part of the government and disappears between elections.

(D) The state has four parts and endures; the government is one of those parts and changes with elections.

9. A diagram shows a large circle labelled X containing four smaller shapes; one of the four shapes is itself a box containing three sub-parts labelled 'makes laws', 'enforces laws', 'interprets laws'. The large circle X and the inner box are best labelled, respectively, as:

(A) The government (X) and the state (the box inside it).

(B) The territory (X) and sovereignty (the box inside it).

(C) The population (X) and the territory (the box inside it).

(D) The state (X) and the government (the box of three organs inside it).

10. Country P passes its laws freely, but agrees by treaty to coordinate trade rules with neighbours while keeping the final power to accept or reject any rule. Country Q must obey every order issued by a foreign capital. Which statement about their sovereignty is correct?

(A) Both fully lack sovereignty, because any cooperation with others ends sovereignty.

(B) P retains sovereignty because it keeps the final power over its own laws; Q lacks full sovereignty because an outside power controls its laws.

(C) Both are fully sovereign, since signing any treaty automatically proves sovereignty.

(D) Q is sovereign and P is not, because P chose to coordinate with neighbours.

11. Which scenario best demonstrates a state EXERCISING its sovereignty?

(A) A minister personally ignores a law he dislikes and faces no consequences.

(B) Its parliament passes and its courts enforce a tax law that no outside power can overrule.

(C) Citizens cast their votes in a general election.

(D) The state marks the boundary line of its territory on a map.

12. A pamphlet says 'the police and the army are the real government, because they hold the weapons.' The chapter's view corrects this how?

(A) The police and army are state machinery that the government directs; holding weapons does not make them the government.

(B) The police and army truly are the government, since force decides who governs.

(C) The police and army are part of the population and have no role for the state.

(D) The police and army are a foreign power placed over the state.

13. After an election, a defeated party complains that 'the same officers, police and soldiers are still in place, so nothing really changed.' What is the accurate response?

- (A) Nothing changed at all, because the police and soldiers should have been replaced with the new party's supporters.
- (B) Everything changed, including all police and soldiers, who are dismissed whenever a party loses.
- (C) The government (the political executive) changed; the permanent state machinery, including police and soldiers, rightly continues serving the state regardless of who wins.
- (D) The complaint proves the police and army are themselves the new government.

14. Which feature most sharply separates the armed forces from the elected government?

- (A) The armed forces are elected by the people every five years.
- (B) The armed forces make the country's laws, unlike the elected government.
- (C) The armed forces are a permanent part of the state's machinery, not a team chosen by voters for a fixed term.
- (D) The armed forces change completely whenever a new party takes power.

15. India is described as a 'democratic republic.' A student asks what each word adds. Which explanation is correct?

- (A) 'Democratic' means the people rule by choosing the government in free elections; 'republic' means the head of state is elected, not a hereditary monarch.
- (B) 'Democratic' means the head of state is hereditary; 'republic' means the people do not vote.
- (C) Both words mean exactly the same thing, so the phrase just repeats itself.
- (D) 'Democratic' refers to the size of the army; 'republic' refers to the size of the territory.

16. The United Kingdom has an elected parliament that runs the country, but its head of state is a hereditary monarch. Sweden and Canada are similar. What does this prove about the claim 'every democracy is a republic'?

- (A) The claim is true, because having a parliament automatically makes a country a republic.
- (B) The claim is false: these countries are democracies yet keep monarchs, so they are not republics.
- (C) The claim is true, because a hereditary monarch makes a country a republic.
- (D) It proves these countries are neither democracies nor republics.

17. Imagine a country whose people elect their lawmakers in free elections, but whose head of state is a king who inherited the throne. How should it be classified?

- (A) A republic but not a democracy.
- (B) Both a democracy and a republic.
- (C) Neither a democracy nor a republic.
- (D) A democracy but not a republic.

18. A country abolishes its hereditary monarchy and now elects its head of state, but only one party is allowed to stand and citizens cannot freely choose. Which label fits best?

- (A) A democracy but not a republic.
- (B) Both a full democracy and a republic.
- (C) A republic but not a true democracy.
- (D) Neither a republic nor anything with an elected head.

19. Which combination of (democracy?, republic?) is IMPOSSIBLE to find described in the chapter's framework for a country with a hereditary monarch as head of state?

- (A) Democracy = yes (a country with a monarch can still elect its lawmakers).
- (B) Republic = yes (because a hereditary monarch is, by definition, not an elected head of state).
- (C) Democracy = no (a country with a monarch might also lack free elections).
- (D) Republic = no (a hereditary monarch means it is not a republic).

20. A village council passes a rule that members of a small minority community must do extra unpaid work that others are spared. Even though most villagers voted for it, a court strikes it down. Which principle best explains why the majority's vote did not settle the matter?

- (A) Guaranteed fundamental rights and the rule of law protect minorities, so a majority cannot trample on their rights.
- (B) The minority always rules over the majority in a democracy.
- (C) Majority votes are never valid for any decision.
- (D) Only the majority has rights, so the rule was simply badly written.

21. A speaker argues, 'Democracy means the majority decides, so whatever 51% want must become law.' What is the strongest objection grounded in this chapter?

- (A) The rule of law and guaranteed rights set limits the majority cannot cross, so 51% cannot override a minority's protected rights.
- (B) There is no objection; in a democracy 51% can indeed pass any law at all.
- (C) The objection is that minorities, not majorities, must always decide every law.
- (D) The objection is that democracies have no laws limiting anyone.

22. How does protecting minority rights against the 'dominance of the majority' show the relationship between the rule of law and mere numbers?

- (A) It shows the majority's wishes always override the law whenever they are large enough.
- (B) It shows the rule of law stands above the mere wishes of the majority, since even a numerical majority must obey constitutional rights.
- (C) It shows minorities are left with no protection in a democracy.
- (D) It shows the Constitution can be freely ignored by whoever has more votes.

23. An old saying warns that without law and order, society becomes 'matsya nyaya,' the law of the fishes. A leader then argues, 'So we need a government precisely to prevent this.'

Which reading is correct?

- (A) Matsya nyaya means the strong devour the weak; government and the rule of law exist to prevent exactly that.
- (B) Matsya nyaya means everyone is automatically equal, so no government is needed.
- (C) Matsya nyaya means fish should make the laws, which the government prevents.
- (D) Matsya nyaya means the weak always defeat the strong, so the strong need protection.

24. Which situation is the clearest real-world picture of matsya nyaya taking hold?

- (A) A court fairly punishes a powerful person who broke the law.
- (B) Citizens peacefully vote out a government they dislike.
- (C) After all police and courts collapse, the most powerful gangs seize others' property and no one can be held to account.
- (D) A regulator fines a large company for breaking safety rules.

25. Why is the rule of law described as the opposite of matsya nyaya?

- (A) Because the rule of law binds even the most powerful to follow the law, protecting the weak instead of letting the strong prey on them.
- (B) Because the rule of law lets the powerful ignore the law whenever convenient.
- (C) Because the rule of law applies only to weak and poor people.
- (D) Because the rule of law abolishes the government entirely.

26. A minister says, 'I am part of the government, so the rule of law does not apply to me.' This claim is wrong because the rule of law means:

- (A) Only ordinary citizens, not officials, must obey the law.
- (B) The government is above the law and writes its own exceptions.
- (C) Everyone, including the government and its ministers, must follow the law.
- (D) Laws apply only to minorities and the weak.

27. Without any government or law, the chapter says society would tend to slide toward which condition, and what does this reveal about why government exists?

- (A) Toward perfect equality requiring no effort, revealing government is unnecessary.
- (B) Toward a fully working Constitution that appears on its own, revealing law needs no enforcer.
- (C) Toward the rule of law forming naturally, revealing the powerful police themselves.
- (D) Toward matsya nyaya (the strong preying on the weak), revealing that government exists to maintain order and protect the weak.

28. A body of elected representatives meets, debates a proposed bill, and votes it into law. A second body then issues orders to carry the new law out across the country. A third body later decides whether someone broke that law. These three actions belong, in order, to the:

- (A) executive, judiciary and legislature. (B) judiciary, legislature and executive.
- (C) legislature, executive and judiciary. (D) legislature, judiciary and executive.

29. The word 'legislature' traces to Latin roots for 'law' and 'a bringing or proposing.' Which organ's defining task does this origin best fit, and why is the match exact?

- (A) The legislature's, because its defining task is precisely to propose and make laws.
- (B) The executive's, because its task is to carry out laws.
- (C) The judiciary's, because its task is to judge and interpret laws.
- (D) The bureaucracy's, because its task is to be selected by exams.

30. A state assembly spends a session amending the wording of a draft education bill and finally votes it into law. Which classification of this work is correct?

- (A) Executive work, because the assembly is enforcing the education policy.
- (B) Legislative work - making law - because debating and passing bills is what a legislature does.
- (C) Judicial work, because the assembly is interpreting the meaning of a law.
- (D) Bureaucratic work, because civil servants are running the session.

31. A citizen says, 'The ministers we elect personally run every government office day to day.' Why is this misleading?

- (A) Because ministers truly do every administrative task alone, with no officials at all.
- (B) Because the courts, not officials, run the daily administration of offices.
- (C) Because the permanent executive - the non-elected, exam-selected bureaucracy - actually implements decisions day to day, whichever party wins.
- (D) Because the legislature personally manages every government office each day.

32. Which contrast between the political executive and the permanent executive is correct?

- (A) The political executive is exam-selected and permanent; the permanent executive is elected and temporary.
- (B) Both are elected for fixed terms and both change at every election.
- (C) Both are exam-selected civil servants who never change and never set policy direction.
- (D) The political executive (ministers) sets direction and changes with elections; the permanent executive (bureaucracy) is exam-selected and stays on whichever party wins.

33. After a change of government, a senior civil servant continues in office and implements the new ministers' lawful decisions. This continuity is valuable mainly because it:

- (A) lets the civil servant make new laws independently of the legislature.
- (B) means the civil servant has become the new political head of state.
- (C) proves the bureaucracy changes completely after each election.
- (D) gives steady, experienced administration so the state runs smoothly whichever party wins.

34. 'Bureaucracy' is best defined as which of the following?

- (A) The elected ministers who set policy and change with each election.
- (B) The judges of the courts who interpret the laws.
- (C) The permanent, non-elected, exam-selected officers (civil servants) who run the day-to-day work of government.
- (D) The voters who choose the government in elections.

35. A government department issues a clearly worded instruction telling local offices how to deliver a welfare scheme passed by the legislature. Which organ-and-part is acting?

- (A) The legislature, because issuing instructions is the same as making a law.
- (B) The judiciary, because the department is settling a legal dispute.
- (C) The executive - specifically the permanent executive (bureaucracy) carrying out a law.
- (D) The political executive alone, with no role for the bureaucracy.

36. The judiciary is sometimes called a 'watchdog.' A new law is passed that conflicts with the Constitution. Acting as a watchdog, the judiciary can:

- (A) rewrite the law itself into a better version and pass it.
- (B) examine the law and strike it down through judicial review because it violates the Constitution.
- (C) order the legislature to hold a fresh election immediately.
- (D) do nothing, since courts must obey whatever the legislature passes.

37. Why does an INDEPENDENT judiciary matter for the rule of law?

- (A) Because only a judiciary free from the ruling party's control can fairly check even the government's own actions against the Constitution.
- (B) Because it lets the ruling party control the courts and approve its own laws.
- (C) Because it makes the courts obey the ministers' wishes.
- (D) Because it removes all checks on those who hold power.

38. Match each organ to its defining verb: which set is entirely correct?

- (A) Legislature - enforces; Executive - interprets; Judiciary - makes.
- (B) Legislature - makes; Executive - enforces; Judiciary - interprets.
- (C) Legislature - interprets; Executive - makes; Judiciary - enforces.
- (D) Legislature - makes; Executive - interprets; Judiciary - enforces.

39. Judicial review allows the judiciary to strike down a law that breaks the Constitution. Which action would FALL OUTSIDE this power as the chapter describes it?

- (A) Examining whether a law violates the Constitution.
- (B) Striking down a government action that breaks the Constitution.
- (C) Deciding whether a passed law is consistent with constitutional rights.
- (D) Writing and passing a brand-new tax law to replace the one it struck down.

40. A school principal acts in three ways during one term: she keeps students safe (role 1), runs the library and meals (role 2), and sets and enforces fair rules for clubs (role 3). If the principal models the government, which labels fit roles 1, 2 and 3?

- (A) Legislature, executive and judiciary. (B) Union, state and local.
- (C) Protector, provider and regulator. (D) Population, territory and sovereignty.

41. Which government action belongs to the PROTECTOR role and not the others?

- (A) Building and staffing new public hospitals across districts.
- (B) Setting safety standards that factories must follow.
- (C) Counting and announcing the results of a general election.
- (D) Deploying the armed forces to defend the country's borders from attack.

42. A government opens new public schools, runs hospitals, and lays roads. A critic says 'this is the government acting as a regulator.' What is the correct classification and why?

- (A) It is the provider role, because the government is supplying services like schools, hospitals and roads.
- (B) It is the regulator role, because building things means setting rules for them.
- (C) It is the protector role, because schools and hospitals keep people safe.
- (D) It is the legislative organ, because building is the same as making laws.

43. A regulator (from Latin regula, 'rule') sets and enforces fair rules. Which pair of actions BOTH belong to the regulator role?

- (A) Sending soldiers to the border, and building a public hospital.
- (B) Building roads, and counting votes in an election.
- (C) Defending the coastline, and supplying free textbooks to schools.
- (D) Inspecting factories for safety compliance, and fixing fair rules for trade in a market.

44. Which single scenario shows the government playing ALL THREE of its roles - protector, provider and regulator?

- (A) It only guards the coast, builds nothing, and sets no rules.
- (B) It only runs hospitals and schools, with no defence and no rule-setting.
- (C) It guards the coast with the navy, runs government hospitals, and inspects food shops for hygiene rules.
- (D) It only inspects shops and sets market rules, with no defence and no services.

45. The Right to Information (RTI) lets citizens ask the government about its actions. How does this most directly strengthen democracy?

- (A) It lets citizens vote more than once in an election.
- (B) It lets citizens appoint the judges of the courts.
- (C) It lets citizens ignore laws they disagree with.
- (D) It brings transparency and accountability, since citizens can see what the government is doing and question it.

46. A government is performing badly. Which combination lists ONLY genuine ways citizens hold a government accountable?

- (A) Refusing to vote, leaving every decision to one minister, and abolishing the Constitution.
- (B) Using RTI, reporting through a free media, organising in civil society, and voting the government out.
- (C) Appointing themselves as judges, dismissing soldiers, and writing new laws personally.
- (D) Ignoring elections, attacking the courts, and obeying the strongest gang.

47. When citizens vote a poorly performing government out of office at the next election, the principle they are exercising is best named:

- (A) sovereignty exercised over a foreign state.
- (B) accountability - holding the government answerable for its performance.
- (C) the regulator role of government.
- (D) judicial review of the laws.

48. A free press publishes an investigation exposing wasted public funds, prompting public pressure and an official inquiry. Which role does this illustrate?

- (A) The media keeping the government accountable to citizens.
- (B) The media making new laws for the country.
- (C) The media replacing the courts and deciding the case.
- (D) The media running the day-to-day bureaucracy.

49. A citizen whose ration card was wrongly cancelled files a complaint through an official channel and gets it corrected. This 'grievance redressal' is best understood as:

- (A) a form of accountability that lets citizens raise and resolve problems with government services.
- (B) a way for citizens to vote in foreign elections.
- (C) a way for citizens to appoint ministers.
- (D) a way for citizens to strike down laws they dislike.

50. India's government works at three tiers. Which set names them correctly, and which common error do the distractors make?

- (A) Legislature, executive and judiciary; these are the tiers of government.
- (B) Union, state and local tiers; the distractors confuse tiers with organs, roles or the parts of a state.
- (C) Protector, provider and regulator; these are the tiers of government.
- (D) Population, territory and sovereignty; these are the tiers of government.

51. Decentralisation is the idea behind having union, state and local tiers. Which statement captures its purpose correctly?

- (A) It concentrates all power in one central office for efficiency.
- (B) It spreads power so that matters are decided at the level closest to the people affected.
- (C) It abolishes local government so the centre decides everything.
- (D) It hands a state's powers to a foreign country.

52. A pothole on a neighbourhood lane is repaired after the local municipal body decides on it, rather than waiting for the union government in the capital. This best illustrates:

- (A) concentrating all power at the centre.
- (B) decentralisation - deciding a local matter at the local level.
- (C) abolishing the local tier of government.
- (D) handing control to a foreign power.

53. Federalism (from Latin foedus, 'treaty') describes how power is arranged in India. Which statement is correct?

- (A) One central government holds all power alone, with no shares for states.
- (B) There is no central government at all, only local bodies.
- (C) A single hereditary king holds all the power.
- (D) Power is shared between a central government and state and local governments.

54. Which arrangement best shows federalism AND decentralisation working together in India?

- (A) The union government decides every matter, from national defence to a single village's drains.
- (B) There is no central government, and each village is fully independent.
- (C) Power is shared among union, state and local governments, with local bodies deciding local matters.
- (D) A monarch in the capital personally approves every local decision.

55. A student writes three claims: (1) 'the government is the same as the state'; (2) 'in a democracy the majority can do anything it wants'; (3) 'every democracy is a republic.' How many are correct, and what is the best single correction?

- (A) All three are correct as written.
- (B) Only the first is wrong; the other two are correct.
- (C) Only the third is wrong; the first two are correct.
- (D) Zero are correct: the government is only one part of the state; rights and the rule of law protect minorities from the majority; and some democracies (like the UK) keep monarchs and so are not republics.

56. A country has a free, fairly elected parliament; its head of state is an elected president; courts can strike down unconstitutional laws; and minority rights are protected against majority votes. Which set of labels ALL correctly apply?

- (A) Democracy, republic, judicial review present, and rule of law over the majority.
- (B) Monarchy, no judicial review, and majority rule without limits.

- (C) Democracy but not a republic, with the majority able to do anything.
- (D) Republic but not a democracy, with courts unable to check laws.

57. Trace the path of a single rule from idea to enforcement to challenge. Parliament passes a road-safety law; the transport bureaucracy enforces it across districts; a citizen argues in court that it violates a constitutional right and the court agrees and strikes it down. Which mapping of organs is correct?

- (A) Legislature made it, the executive (permanent bureaucracy) enforced it, and the judiciary used judicial review to strike it down.
- (B) The judiciary made it, the legislature enforced it, and the executive struck it down.
- (C) The executive made it, the judiciary enforced it, and the legislature struck it down.
- (D) The bureaucracy made it, the courts enforced it, and Parliament struck it down.

58. After an election, ALL of the following stay in place EXCEPT one. Which one is REPLACED, identifying the part of the system that actually turns over?

- (A) The state's territory is replaced.
- (B) The permanent bureaucracy is replaced.
- (C) The political executive (the team of ministers) is replaced.
- (D) The state's sovereignty is replaced.

59. A commentator argues, 'Because India is a democracy, its courts must simply do whatever the majority's elected government wants.' Which two chapter ideas TOGETHER best refute this?

- (A) Decentralisation and federalism - sharing power means courts must obey the centre.
- (B) The provider and protector roles - because providing services means courts follow ministers.
- (C) Judicial independence and the rule of law - independent courts check even the elected government, which is bound by the law like everyone else.
- (D) Sovereignty and territory - because a state's borders decide how courts must rule.

60. Which statement weaves the chapter's ideas together CORRECTLY?

- (A) The state endures with its four parts while the government (one part, run through three organs and playing three roles) changes at elections, all under the rule of law.
- (B) The government endures with four parts while the state changes at every election under the majority's unlimited will.
- (C) The state and the government are identical, both governed only by whatever the majority decides.
- (D) The three tiers (union, state, local) are the same as the three organs (legislature, executive, judiciary).

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 18: The State, the Government, and You — Paper 3

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	B	21	A	31	C	41	D	51	B
2	D	12	A	22	B	32	D	42	A	52	B
3	B	13	C	23	A	33	D	43	D	53	D
4	D	14	C	24	C	34	C	44	C	54	C
5	D	15	A	25	A	35	C	45	D	55	D
6	A	16	B	26	C	36	B	46	B	56	A
7	C	17	D	27	D	37	A	47	B	57	A
8	D	18	C	28	C	38	B	48	A	58	C
9	D	19	B	29	A	39	D	49	A	59	C
10	B	20	A	30	B	40	C	50	B	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (B) Of a state's four parts (population, territory, government, sovereignty), only the government changes at elections; the other three persisted here, so the state endured while the government changed. Saying the state changed but the government stayed reverses the two. Saying both were replaced ignores that the people, land and sovereignty continued. Saying nothing can ever change is false - governments routinely change at elections.

2. (D) The four parts of a state are population, territory, government and sovereignty. An independent judiciary is an organ within the government, not one of the four parts of the state itself, so it is the imposter. Population, territory and sovereignty are three of the genuine four; the missing fourth is the government as a whole, of which the judiciary is only one organ.

3. (B) The analogy maps the lasting school to the state and the changing teachers to the government. Its warning is precisely against thinking the state dies when a government leaves - the wrong conclusion. The other three are exactly what the analogy DOES support:

governments change while the state continues, the state outlasts any one government, and successive governments run the same state.

4. (D) A state is a political organisation governing a defined territory and population, possessing sovereignty - it has four parts and endures across elections. Riya reduces it to mere buildings; Sam confuses it with the current government (one changing part). Both errors mistake a part or a place for the whole enduring state, so neither is right and 'both right' compounds both mistakes.

5. (D) Sovereignty is a state's full power to make and enforce its own laws without outside control. A nation that needs a neighbour's approval for its laws lacks exactly this. It already has population (settled people) and territory (marked borders), and it does have a government making laws - the defect is that those laws are not free of outside control, i.e. sovereignty is missing.

6. (A) Making, enforcing and interpreting laws is the government's job, carried out by the legislature, executive and judiciary respectively. The population votes but does not itself write and judge laws; the territory is land, not an actor; sovereignty is the power that backs the laws, not an organ that drafts and judges them. Only the first option correctly assigns the work to the government's organs.

7. (C) When a party loses, a new government simply takes office; existing laws remain in force until changed, and sovereignty belongs to the enduring state, not to any party. So none of the three is lost. Claiming all three vanish confuses the government with the whole state; the partial-loss options wrongly tie sovereignty or the body of laws to one party's term.

8. (D) The state comprises population, territory, government and sovereignty and persists over time; the government is just one of those four parts and is the part that changes at elections. The first distractor swaps state and government. The second wrongly says both change identically - the state endures. The third inverts the whole-part relationship, making the larger state a piece of the smaller government.

9. (D) The large circle holding four parts is the state (population, territory, government, sovereignty). The inner box whose sub-parts make, enforce and interpret laws is the government, with its legislature, executive and judiciary. The distractors invert the whole-part relation or mislabel the circle and box as territory, sovereignty or population, none of which split into three law-handling organs.

10. (B) Sovereignty is the full power to make and enforce one's own laws without outside control. P keeps the final say even while cooperating, so it stays sovereign; Q must obey a foreign capital, so an outside power controls its laws and its sovereignty is incomplete. Voluntary coordination where the state keeps the final word does not end sovereignty, so

'both lack it' is wrong; and being controlled from abroad (Q) is the opposite of sovereignty, so the last option is reversed.

11. (B) Sovereignty is the power to make and enforce one's own laws free of outside control; a parliament passing and courts enforcing a law no foreign power can overrule is exactly that power in action. A minister ignoring the law is a breach of the rule of law, not sovereignty. Voting expresses democracy. Marking a border concerns territory, another part of the state - not the exercise of sovereignty over law-making.

12. (A) The police and the army are part of the state's machinery, directed by the elected government; they enforce, but they do not make or interpret laws and are not the government. Equating force with government is the misconception the chapter rejects. Calling them merely 'population with no role' ignores their enforcement function, and calling them foreign is absurd - they belong to the state.

13. (C) Elections change the political executive (ministers), while permanent state machinery - the bureaucracy, police and armed forces - continues so the state runs smoothly. So a real change (the government) occurred even though the permanent machinery stayed. Replacing officers with party supporters would politicise neutral machinery; mass dismissals do not happen; and continuity of the police does not make them the government.

14. (C) The elected government is chosen by voters for a fixed term and changes at elections; the armed forces are permanent state machinery that endures across governments - this is the sharp difference. They are not elected, they do not make laws (that is the legislature's work), and they do not turn over with each new party - that continuity is precisely what distinguishes them.

15. (A) Democracy concerns WHO rules - the people, through free and fair elections. Republic concerns the HEAD OF STATE being elected rather than inheriting the position. The first option keeps these distinct and correct. The second reverses both meanings, the third wrongly treats them as identical, and the fourth attaches them to the army and territory, which have nothing to do with these terms.

16. (B) A republic requires an ELECTED (non-hereditary) head of state. The UK, Sweden and Canada elect their parliaments (democratic) but keep hereditary monarchs as heads of state, so they are democracies but not republics - disproving the claim. A parliament does not by itself make a republic; a hereditary monarch is the very opposite of a republic; and these countries clearly are democracies, so 'neither' is wrong.

17. (D) Free elections of lawmakers make it a democracy (the people rule). A hereditary king as head of state means it is NOT a republic, which requires an elected head of state. So it is a democracy but not a republic. 'Republic but not democracy' reverses the facts;

'both' ignores the hereditary king; 'neither' ignores the free elections that make it democratic.

18. (C) Electing the head of state (no hereditary monarch) makes it a republic. But if only one party may stand and people cannot freely choose, it lacks the free and fair elections that define democracy, so it is a republic but not a true democracy. 'Democracy but not republic' reverses this; 'both' ignores the lack of real choice; and it does have an elected head, so 'neither' is wrong.

19. (B) A republic requires an elected, non-hereditary head of state, so a country with a hereditary monarch can NEVER be a republic - 'republic = yes' is impossible for it. It can, however, be a democracy if it elects its lawmakers (like the UK), or fail to be one if elections are not free; and 'republic = no' is exactly the correct classification for a monarchy. Hence the impossible case is republic = yes.

20. (A) In a democracy the majority cannot do whatever it wants: constitutional rights and the rule of law shield minorities from the 'dominance of the majority,' which is why the court could strike the rule down. The minority does not rule over the majority; majority votes are valid for many things but not to violate rights; and the idea that only the majority has rights is exactly the misconception being corrected.

21. (A) The chapter stresses that the majority cannot do anything it likes; constitutional rights and the rule of law bind even a majority. So 51% cannot trample protected rights - that is the strongest objection. Saying 51% can pass anything endorses the very error; saying minorities must decide everything is the opposite extreme; and saying democracies have no limiting laws contradicts the rule of law.

22. (B) Protecting minorities demonstrates that the rule of law - everyone, including a majority, must follow the law - is stronger than the bare wishes of the majority. The other options invert this: that majorities override the law, that minorities have no protection, or that the Constitution can be ignored by the larger group - each contradicts the rule of law the chapter upholds.

23. (A) 'Matsya nyaya,' the law of the fishes, describes a lawless world where the powerful prey on the weak; we need a government and the rule of law to keep order and prevent this. The other options misread the phrase: it does not mean automatic equality, it is not literally about fish legislating, and it is the strong who dominate the weak, not the reverse.

24. (C) Matsya nyaya is the lawless state where the strong prey on the weak with no accountability - exactly the collapse of police and courts letting powerful gangs dominate. The other three are the OPPOSITE: a court punishing the powerful, peaceful voting, and a regulator fining a big company all show the rule of law working to restrain the strong.

25. (A) Matsya nyaya lets the strong dominate the weak; the rule of law is its opposite because it subjects everyone - including the powerful and the government - to the law,

shielding the weak. Letting the powerful ignore the law would BE matsya nyaya; applying law only to the weak contradicts equal application; and the rule of law needs a government to enforce it, not its abolition.

26. (C) The rule of law holds that no one is above the law - the government and its ministers included. A minister claiming exemption contradicts this core idea. The distractors each restate a version of the very error: exempting officials, placing the government above the law, or applying law only to certain groups - all of which the rule of law rejects.

27. (D) Lawlessness slides toward matsya nyaya, where the powerful dominate the weak - which is exactly why a government and the rule of law are needed to keep order. The distractors imagine that equality, a Constitution, or the rule of law would appear by themselves without any enforcer, contradicting the chapter's point that order must be actively maintained.

28. (C) Passing a bill into law is the legislature's job; carrying it out is the executive's; deciding whether it was broken is the judiciary's. So the order is legislature, executive, judiciary. The distractors scramble this mapping - for example placing enforcement before law-making, or judging before law-making - none of which matches what each organ actually does.

29. (A) 'Legislature' = lex ('law') + a root meaning to bring or propose, matching exactly its defining task of making and proposing laws. 'To carry out' is the root of executive (exsequi); 'judge' (judex) is the root behind judiciary; the bureaucracy is the permanent executive defined by service, not by an etymology about proposing law. Only the legislature fits.

30. (B) Amending and voting a bill into law is law-making, the legislature's defining function. It is not executive enforcement (no carrying-out of an existing law), not judicial interpretation (no dispute being decided), and not bureaucratic administration (elected representatives, not civil servants, are passing the bill). So it is legislative work.

31. (C) The executive has two parts: the political executive (ministers, who set direction and change with elections) and the permanent executive (the bureaucracy of civil servants, who actually run day-to-day administration across governments). So the daily running is done by the bureaucracy, not ministers alone. Courts interpret law and the legislature makes it - neither runs daily administration.

32. (D) Ministers form the political executive - elected, direction-setting, changing with elections. Civil servants form the permanent executive - exam-selected and continuing across governments to give stable administration. The first distractor swaps the two; the second wrongly makes the bureaucracy elected and temporary; the third wrongly makes

ministers permanent exam-selected officials. Only the correct option keeps each in its right role.

33. (D) The permanent executive stays on across governments precisely to provide stable, continuous administration regardless of which party is in power. Civil servants implement, but do not make, laws; they are not the head of state; and their staying on shows the bureaucracy does NOT change completely after each election - the very opposite of the last distractor.

34. (C) The bureaucracy is the permanent executive: non-elected civil servants, usually chosen by competitive exams, who carry out administration across governments. Elected ministers are the political executive; judges form the judiciary; voters are the electorate. Each distractor names a different actor in the system, none of which is the bureaucracy.

35. (C) Carrying out a law by instructing local offices is executive work, and the routine implementation is done by the permanent executive (the bureaucracy). It is not legislation - the law already exists; it is not adjudication - no dispute is being decided; and while ministers set direction, the day-to-day implementation is the bureaucracy's, so 'no role for the bureaucracy' is wrong.

36. (B) Judicial review is the judiciary's power to examine laws and government actions and strike down those that breach the Constitution - exactly the watchdog role. Courts do not write and pass laws (that is the legislature), do not order elections, and are not bound to accept an unconstitutional law - so the other options either give courts legislative power or strip them of their checking role.

37. (A) Independence lets the judiciary check even the government fairly, upholding the rule of law - everyone, including the government, must follow the law. The distractors describe the opposite of independence: courts controlled by the ruling party, obeying ministers, or imposing no checks - each of which would let power escape the law rather than be held to it.

38. (B) The legislature makes laws, the executive enforces them, and the judiciary interprets them and settles disputes - the only fully correct set. Each distractor misassigns at least one verb, such as making the legislature enforce, the executive interpret, or the judiciary make laws, none of which matches the organs' actual functions.

39. (D) Judicial review is the power to EXAMINE and STRIKE DOWN unconstitutional laws and actions - not to write and pass new laws, which is the legislature's job, so that falls outside it. Examining a law, striking down an unconstitutional action, and checking a law against constitutional rights are all squarely within judicial review.

40. (C) Keeping people safe is the protector role, supplying services is the provider role, and setting and enforcing fair rules is the regulator role - the government's triple role. The

distractors list the three organs, the three tiers, and the four parts of a state respectively - none of which describes 'keeps safe / supplies services / sets rules.'

41. (D) Defending the country and keeping citizens safe is the protector role. Building hospitals is the provider role (supplying services); setting factory safety standards is the regulator role (making and enforcing rules); and announcing election results is part of running elections, not the protector role. Only border defence is purely protection.

42. (A) Supplying services such as schools, hospitals and roads is the provider role. The regulator role is about setting and enforcing fair rules, not building services, so the critic is wrong. Calling it protection confuses 'providing services' with 'defending the country and keeping people safe,' and building is certainly not law-making by the legislature.

43. (D) Both inspecting factories for safety and fixing fair market rules are about setting and enforcing rules - the regulator role. The other pairs mix protector (border, coastline defence) and provider (hospital, roads, textbooks) actions; none of those pairs is purely regulation, so only the first option has two genuine regulator actions.

44. (C) Guarding the coast is protection, running hospitals is provision, and inspecting shops for hygiene rules is regulation - all three roles at once. Each distractor shows only ONE role (defence only, services only, or rule-setting only), so none demonstrates all three the way the correct option does.

45. (D) RTI lets citizens request information about government actions, increasing transparency and enabling them to hold the government accountable. It has nothing to do with extra voting, appointing judges (a judicial matter), or ignoring laws (which would break the rule of law). Only transparency and accountability is the correct, direct effect.

46. (B) Accountability tools include RTI, a free media exposing failures, civil-society pressure, grievance redressal, and voting a poor government out - all in the first option. The others list the OPPOSITE: refusing to vote, one-minister rule and scrapping the Constitution remove accountability; appointing oneself judge or dismissing soldiers is unlawful; ignoring elections and obeying a gang invites matsya nyaya.

47. (B) Removing a poor government by vote is a core way citizens hold it accountable for its record. It is not sovereignty over a foreign state (sovereignty is the state's power over its own laws), not the government's regulator role (citizens are acting, not the government), and not judicial review (a power of the courts, not of voters).

48. (A) By exposing failures and informing citizens, a free media helps hold the government accountable - exactly what the investigation did. The media does not make laws (the legislature's job), does not judge cases (the judiciary's), and does not run administration (the bureaucracy's); its accountability role is the correct one.

49. (A) Grievance redressal lets citizens complain about and seek fixes for problems with government services, which holds the administration accountable - just as the corrected ration card shows. It is not foreign voting, not appointing ministers (an electoral/political matter), and not striking down laws (that is judicial review by the courts).

50. (B) The three TIERS are union, state and local - levels at which government operates. The distractors mislabel the three ORGANS, the three ROLES, and three PARTS of a state as 'tiers,' a classic mix-up. Only union/state/local are the tiers; the others answer entirely different questions about how government is structured.

51. (B) Decentralisation spreads out power so local matters are settled locally and decisions are made at the appropriate level. The distractors describe its opposite or an unrelated harm: concentrating all power centrally, abolishing local bodies, or surrendering power to a foreign country - none of which is decentralisation.

52. (B) Letting a local body decide a local road repair is decentralisation in action - the matter is handled at the level closest to it. It is the opposite of centralising power, it relies on (not abolishes) the local tier, and it has nothing to do with foreign control, which the other options wrongly describe.

53. (D) Federalism shares power between a central government and the state/local governments - a division of authority rather than concentration in one place. The distractors describe non-federal systems: all power held centrally, no centre at all, or rule by a king - none of which matches the shared-power meaning of federalism.

54. (C) Federalism shares power between the centre and state/local governments; decentralisation lets local matters be decided locally. The correct option shows both - shared tiers plus local decision-making. The distractors are non-federal or non-decentralised: total central control, no centre at all, or a monarch approving everything - none combines shared power with local decision-making.

55. (D) All three claims are misconceptions. The government is just one of the state's four parts. The majority cannot do anything it wants because rights and the rule of law shield minorities. Not every democracy is a republic - the UK is a democracy with a hereditary monarch. So zero are correct, and only the full three-part correction fixes them; the other options leave one or more errors standing.

56. (A) Free elections make it a democracy; an elected head of state makes it a republic; courts striking down unconstitutional laws is judicial review; protecting minorities shows the rule of law over the majority - so all four labels fit. The distractors each contradict the facts: it is not a monarchy, it does have judicial review, the majority is limited by rights, and it clearly is a democracy.

57. (A) Parliament passing the law is legislative; the bureaucracy enforcing it is executive; the court striking it down for breaching a right is judicial review by the judiciary. The

correct option maps these accurately. Each distractor scrambles the organs - for instance making courts legislate or Parliament strike down laws - none of which matches who actually does each step.

58. (C) An election replaces the political executive - the ministers - while the territory, sovereignty and the permanent bureaucracy all continue. So the ministers are the part that turns over. The distractors name things that endure across elections: territory and sovereignty are stable parts of the state, and the bureaucracy is the permanent executive that stays on to give continuity.

59. (C) An independent judiciary can check even the elected government, and the rule of law binds the government like everyone else - together these refute the idea that courts must do the majority's bidding. The distractors pair concepts that are real but irrelevant here (tiers, roles, parts of a state) and even draw wrong conclusions, such as courts being made to obey the centre or ministers.

60. (A) The correct synthesis: the enduring state has four parts; the government is one part, working through three organs and three roles, and it changes at elections, with everyone bound by the rule of law. The distractors embed familiar errors - swapping state and government, conflating the two under unlimited majority rule, or confusing the tiers with the organs - each contradicting the chapter.